

ECON 701: Applied Research Workshop

Summer 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor Name: Gajendran Raveendranathan

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Office hours: By sign up

Course Information

Prerequisites: Pass in Economics 761 and Econ 762 or by permission of instructor

Lecture: Tuesday and Thursday 9:30 am – 11 am (synchronous)

Course Dates: May 5th Tuesday 2026 to July 30th Thursday 2026

Office: Zoom

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: virtual

Course Description: This course trains students to apply the knowledge and skills learned during their Masters coursework to research projects. Students will produce original research in consultation with the instructor and their peers and learn how to convert their research findings into research reports. The course will provide hands-on training, which will prepare students not only for doctoral work, but also provide essential skills needed as an economic analyst.

Meeting Details

Course is offered online synchronously. Announcements will be posted to Avenue to Learn.

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course students should be able to:

1. How to develop a research idea into a research project
2. How to carry out a research project
3. How to write an economic research report

Course Evaluation

1. Ideas presentation (10%)
2. Research progress report (20%)
3. Final research presentation (30%)
4. Final research paper (30%)
5. Class participation (10%)

Ideas presentation (10%), 3rd week of class

- 10–15-minute presentation for each student (exact time: TBD)

Research progress report (20%), due 7th week of class (June 18th at the latest)

Final research presentation (30%), (synchronous: 12th week of class or recorded: submit July 21st at the latest)

- Time duration for each presentation: TBD

Final research paper (30%), 13th week of class (July 30th at the latest)

Note: Research papers must be uploaded in PDF form to Dropbox link that will be provided.

Grading Scale

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Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
F	0	0-69

Course Schedule

Please see below.

Late Assignments

If student misses a presentation, then the grade is 0. For the research paper, 10 percent of the grade will be deducted for each day after the due date.

Absences, Missed Work or Illness

Weights cannot be transferred. Student should contact instructor within 2 days of missing assignment for any consideration. Otherwise, the score for a missed assignment is 0 even if student files for MSAF but does not contact instructor within 2 days of when the assignment was due.

Turnitin.com

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For students using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Course Modification

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme

circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

Generative AI

Students may use generative AI throughout this course in whatever way enhances their learning; no special documentation or citation is required.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

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upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Email Communication

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the "Code"). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated.

Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students' access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28 652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.

Weekly Course Schedule (and/or important dates)

Week 1 (May 5th and 7th)

- *Class meets as a group for some time. Instructor discusses:*
 1. How to go from research idea to research question?
 2. What are the parts of a research project (empirical, theoretical, or a mix of both) and how to carry out economic research?
 3. How to do an economics presentation?
 4. How to write an economics paper?
- *Students will also meet with instructor individually to discuss their research ideas.*
 1. Please sign up on google sheets: <https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1-dHHj6xwHlx5-tmLl0GC4aR3HK9NpHJMM8t7sBrcyvg/edit#gid=0>
 2. Discussion will focus on data sources available and potential theoretical methodologies.

Week 2 (May 12th and 14th)

- May 12th: No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).
- **May 14th: No class.**

Week 3 (May 19th and 21st)

- ***Class meets as a group for ideas presentation.***

Week 4 (May 26th and 28th)

- No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).

Week 5 (June 2nd and June 4th)

- No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).

Week 6 (June 9th and 11th)

- No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).

Week 7 (June 16th and 18th)

- No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).
- *Research progress report is due on June 18th (at the latest)*

Week 8 (June 23rd and 25th)

- No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).

Week 9 (June 30th and July 2nd)

- *No class. Please sign up for meetings by individual appointment via email.*

Week 10 (July 7th and 9th)

- No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).

Week 11 (July 14th and 16th)

- No class meeting. Students must sign up on google sheets for meetings (see A2L).

Week 12 (July 21st and 23rd)

- *Class meets as a group for individual final research presentations.*
- *Last day to submit recorded presentation is July 21st if student is not doing synchronous class presentation*

Week 13 (July 28th and 30th)

- *Class meets as a group for individual final research presentations.*
- *Last day to submit final paper is July 30th*